

Subject-Verb

Agreement

What is 'subject'?

The subject is typically a noun, a noun phrase , or a pronoun. It is the doer or actor of the verb in the sentence.

Example: Rohan, We, My younger brother

Classification of SUBJECT

- Person & Number Wise -

1 st Person		2 nd Person		3 rd Person	
<u>Singular</u>	<u>Plural</u>	<u>Singular</u>	<u>Plural</u>	<u>Singular</u>	<u>Plural</u>
I	We	You	You	He, She, It, This, That, (Any Proper Noun)	They, These, Those, (Plural form of Noun)

What is a verb?

- A **verb** is a word that shows an action or state of being. In other words, they explain what something is or is doing.

He **ran** quickly. (action)

He **is** happy. (state of being)

Types of Verb

Principal or Main Verb

Read, Look, Sleep, Climb, Say, See,
Bring, Pull, Cook, Swim and so on...

Auxiliary or Helping Verb

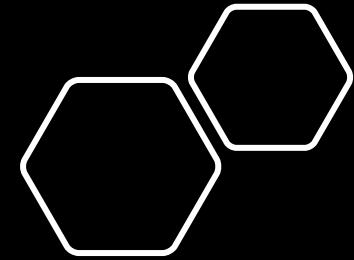
Am, Is, Are, Have, Has, Had, Was,
Were, Shall, Will etc.

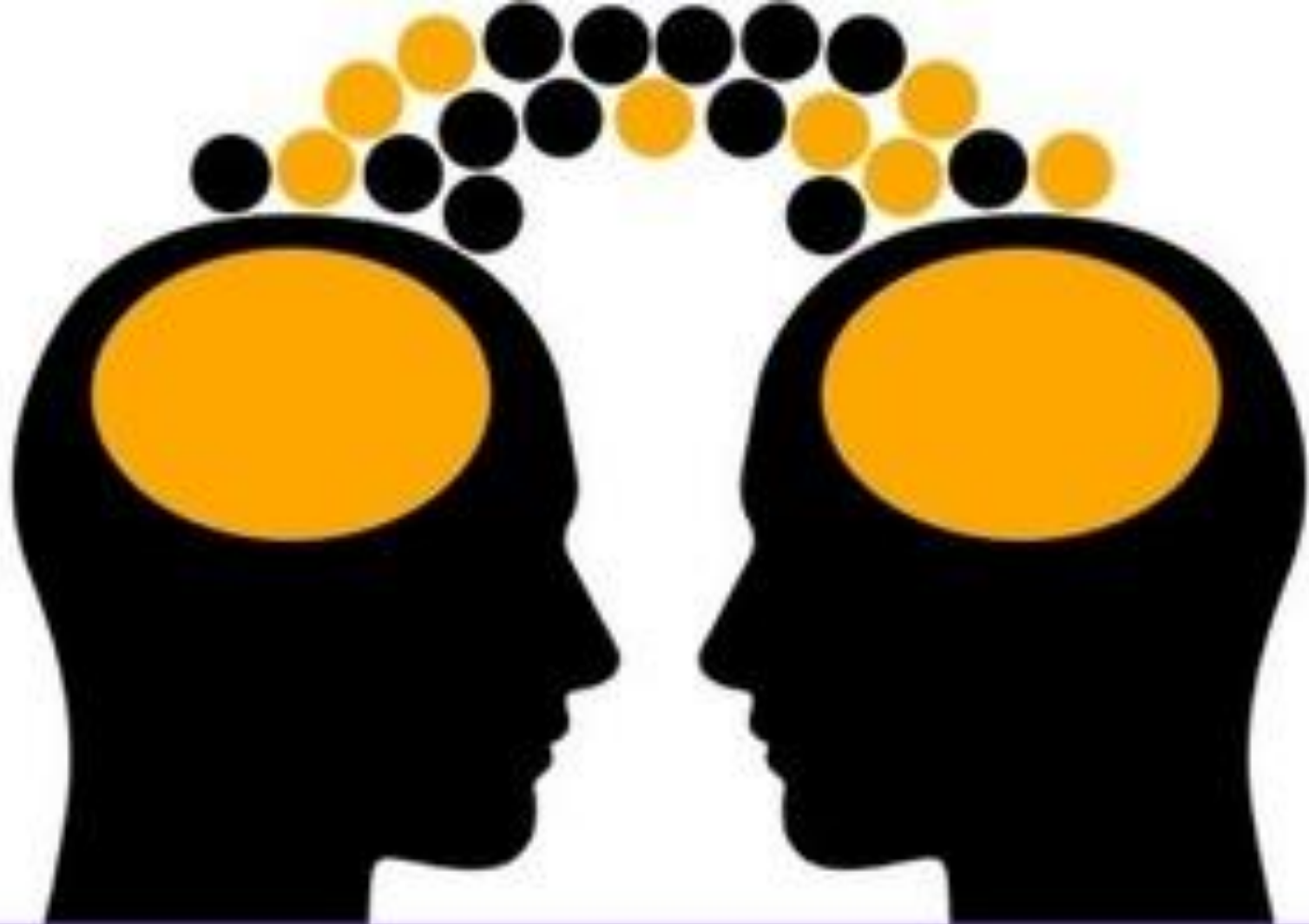
Subject & Helping Verb Agreement

1st Person Singular	Do, Did, Am, Have, Was, Had, Shall, Will
1st Person Plural	Do, Did, Are, Have, Were, Had, Shall, Will
2nd Person Singular	Do, Did, Are, Have, Were, Had, Will
2nd Person Plural	Do, Did, Are, Have, Were, Had, Will
3rd Person Singular	Does, Did, Is, Has, Was, Had, Will
3rd Person Plural	Does, Did, Are, Have, Were, Had, Will

Definition

- Subject-Verb Agreement refers to the relationship between the verb and its subject.
- Every clause or sentence must agree in *number* and *person* with its subject.
- Verb must be singular if its subject is singular; verb must be plural if its subject is plural.





Subject Verb Agreement Rules

1.If the subject is singular, the verb must be singular too. If the subject is plural, the verb must also be plural

Example:

- a) *She* writes every day.
- b) *They* write every day.
- c) *Santana* is a singer.
- d) *The girls* are waiting for you.

2. i) When two subjects are joined by '**AND**' the verb must be plural.

Example:

- a) My friend and his sister **are** going to visit Shimla in summer vacation.
- b) Krish and Radha **are** on their way to the airport.

ii) When two singular subjects are practically synonymous the verb should be in the singular form.

- a) Peace and Prosperity is the need to the day.
- b) The law and order situation in the state is under control.

3. When two subjects are joined by '**OR**' the verb must be according to the closest subject.

Example:

My brother or my friend is going to pick my father.

I think Rahul or his classmates are preparing the science model.

4. When the subjects joined by '**EITHER-OR**' or '**NEITHER-NOR**', the verb will agree in person and number with the noun nearest to it.

Example:

Either Radha or Rani has articulated this speech.

Neither duck nor gees are available in the zoo.

5. When '**not only-but also**' is used to combine two subjects, the verb agrees with the subject close to it.

Example:

a) Not only Hari, but also his brothers were arrested.

b) Not only the captain but also the entire team is working hard.

6. Indefinite pronouns (anybody, anything, each, everybody, everything, nobody, none, one, somebody, either, neither) are considered as singular subject.

Example:

- a) **Everyone** in this class is an intelligent scholar of every time.
- b) **Each** of the participants was willing to be recorded.

7. When you have sentences that begin with 'here', 'there', 'this', 'that', 'those', 'these', etc., always remember that the subject follows the verb and therefore the verb must be joined with reference to the subject.

Example:

- a) **Here** is your book.
- b) **There** lies your shirt.
- c) **That** was a great movie.
- d) **There** have been many changes in the timetable.

8. Collective nouns are words that imply more than one person but are considered singular and take a singular verb.

Example:

a) **The group** meets every week.

b) **The committee** agrees on the quality of the writing.

However, the plural verb is used if the focus is on the individuals in the group. This is much less common.

Example:

a) **The committee members** participate in various volunteer activities in their private lives.

b) **The staff members** disagree on the proposal.

9. The following words may be singular or plural, depending upon their use in a sentence: **some, any, all, most.**

Example:

a) Most of the news is good. (singular)

b) Most of the flowers were yellow. (plural)

c) All of the pizza was gone. (singular)

d) All of the children were late. (plural)

10. Some nouns, while plural in form, are actually singular in meaning

mumps, home economics, social studies economics, measles, calisthenics, statistics, civics, physics, gymnastics, phonics, news, acrobatics, aesthetics, thesis, mathematics

Example:

- a) Mathematics is (not are) an easy subject for some people.
- b) Physics is (not are) taught by Prof, Baldwin.

11. Abstract nouns and uncountable nouns are considered as singular subjects, so make sure you use a singular verb along with it.

Example:

- a) Honesty is the best policy.
- b) Love makes people do crazy things.
- c) Good friendship keeps your mind and body healthy.

12. When a phrase comes between the subject and the verb, remember that the verb still agrees with the subject, not the noun or pronoun in the phrase following the subject of the sentence.

Example:

- a) **The student**, as well as the committee members, is excited.
- b) **The student** with all the master's degrees is very motivated.
- c) **The focus** of the interviews was nine purposively selected participants.

13. Some countable nouns in English such as *earnings, goods, odds, surroundings, proceeds, contents, and valuables* only have a plural form and take a plural verb.

Example:

- a) **The earnings** for this quarter exceed expectations.
- b) **The proceeds** from the sale go to support the homeless population in the city.

14. Expressions of *time, money, measurement, and weight* are usually singular when the amount is considered one unit

Example:

- a) Five dollars is (not are) too much to ask.
- b) Ten days is (not are) not nearly enough time.

On occasion, however these terms are used in the plural sense:

- a) There were thirty minutes to countdown.